Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Introduction

This report documents my work completed as part of the Digital Ambassador Programme, at VIT Bhopal University. The modules are designed to build core digital literacy skills that are essential for students entering a technology-driven professional environment.

The project is structured across five interconnected tasks.

Task 1 required creating an informative digital literacy poster using a design tool.

Task 2 involved setting up professional digital profiles on industry-relevant platforms.

Task 3 focused on hands-on coding practice and creating an online quiz.

Task 4 addressed professional email communication etiquette.

Task 5 involved researching cybercrime, creating awareness materials, and reflecting on personal online safety habits.

Together, these tasks have helped me develop practical skills in digital communication, online safety, coding, and professional networking — all of which are directly relevant to my B.Tech programme and future career.

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Poster

For this task, I designed an informative poster titled 'Mastering Your Digital Life' using Canva, a web-based graphic design platform that allows users to create professional visual content through drag-and-drop templates and customisable design elements.

The poster is structured around four key themes. First, it defines Digital Literacy as the ability to use technology and the internet safely and effectively. Second, it highlights useful digital tools for students — Cloud Storage, GitHub, and Collaborative Platforms — that support academic work, version control, and teamwork. Third, it presents Safe Internet Practices, reminding students to use strong passwords, avoid phishing links, and update their privacy settings. Fourth, it covers Email Etiquette — emphasising the importance of clear subject lines, maintaining a professional tone, and responding to messages in a timely manner.

The most interesting aspect was designing the poster in a dark, tech-inspired aesthetic using neon blue and red tones to appeal to a student audience. This reinforced that good design is not just about appearance — it also shapes how seriously the audience takes the message.

The main difficulty was creating a visual hierarchy that guided the viewer naturally from one section to the next without the design feeling cluttered.

Task 2 — Professional Digital Profiles

For this task, I created and set up professional profiles on three platforms that are widely used across the technology and data science industry.

GitHub (github.com) is a version control and code hosting platform used by developers worldwide to store, manage, and collaborate on software projects. I will use GitHub to host my college projects, track changes to my code over time, and build a public portfolio that I can share with recruiters and internship coordinators.

LinkedIn (linkedin.com) is the world's largest professional networking platform. It functions as a digital CV where I can showcase my education, skills, certifications, and work experience. I plan to use it to connect with industry professionals, follow companies I am interested in, and apply for internships from my second year onwards.

Kaggle (kaggle.com) is the leading data science and machine learning community platform. It provides free datasets, practice notebooks, and competitions. As a CSE student, I will use Kaggle to sharpen my Python and machine learning skills and participate in competitions to build a verifiable track record in data science.

Over the next four years, I plan to progressively build my presence on all three platforms — starting with uploading assignments on GitHub and completing beginner courses on Kaggle, and moving towards open-source contributions and industry certifications by my third and fourth years.

Task 3 — Coding Practice & Online Quiz

For this task, I used two platforms: CodeChef for coding practice and Google Forms to create a digital literacy quiz.

CodeChef (codechef.com) is a competitive programming and technical assessment platform used by companies including Google, Microsoft, and Amazon for evaluating candidates. I practised Java programming on CodeChef , working through problems covering variables, loops, string manipulation, and list comprehension. Java is one of the primary language in my CSE curriculum and is widely applied in areas such as data science, web development, and automation. Practising on CodeChef has helped me build problem-solving speed and logical thinking skills that are directly relevant to technical interviews and placements.

Google Forms was used to create an online quiz testing knowledge of Digital Literacy topics covered in this module. The quiz covers cybercrime types, online safety practices, responsible social media use, and digital tools. It can be accessed at: https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLScalUXrEaMwYhlkpasD3horrlCbKuQVx4SNRrOXNZAG_EzYlg/viewform?usp=sharing&ouid=115995009883333267423

Google Forms is a free, accessible tool that auto-records responses and generates visual summaries. Academically, it will be useful for conducting peer assessments, collecting data for research projects, and designing feedback surveys throughout my degree.

Task 4 — Professional Email Communication

This task required drafting two professional emails that demonstrate correct email etiquette: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor, and one expressing interest in a summer internship.

A real-world scenario illustrating the consequences of poor digital communication is the 2020 Twitter Bitcoin Phishing Scam. Hackers impersonated Twitter's IT department over the phone, tricking employees into sharing their admin credentials. The result was the hijacking of verified accounts belonging to Barack Obama, Elon Musk, and Apple — with over $120,000 stolen from the public within hours.

The key learning from this incident is that professional communication requires verification at every step. Employees should have confirmed the caller's identity through internal channels before sharing any credentials. This case shows that unclear or unverified communication — even by experienced professionals — can have severe consequences, and that email and phone etiquette are critical safety skills, not just formalities.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness & Reflection

Before this module, I was aware of common online scams but did not know how sophisticated they had become. What genuinely surprised me was the 'Digital Arrest' UPI scam — a method where fraudsters impersonate CBI or police officials on WhatsApp video calls, use AI voice cloning to mimic trusted authorities, and keep victims under 'virtual surveillance' for hours until they transfer large sums of money out of fear. I did not expect that artificial intelligence could be weaponised so convincingly in everyday fraud. The 2024 case of S.P. Oswal, Chairman of Vardhman Group, losing ₹7 crore to this exact method showed that even highly educated and experienced individuals can be deceived.

The one habit I will change as a direct result of this module is to never act on any financial or legal instruction received over a phone or video call without independently verifying it through an official channel. I now understand that no legitimate government agency will demand an immediate UPI transfer, and I will treat any such pressure as an immediate red flag.

Conclusion

This project has been a practical and eye-opening experience in building digital literacy. Through the five tasks, I have developed skills across graphic design, professional networking, coding, quiz creation, and email communication — all of which are directly applicable to my academic and professional life. Most significantly, researching cybercrime has fundamentally changed how I approach my own digital behaviour. I now understand that staying safe online is an active, continuous responsibility rather than a passive assumption. The knowledge gained from this module will serve as a strong foundation for my four years at VIT Bhopal University and the career that follows.

References

Tools & Platforms Used

[1] Canva — Online Graphic Design Tool. www.canva.com

[2] GitHub — Code Hosting and Version Control Platform. www.github.com

[3] LinkedIn — Professional Networking Platform. www.linkedin.com

[4] Kaggle — Data Science and ML Community. www.kaggle.com

[5] CodeChef — Coding Practice and Assessment Platform. https://www.codechef.com/

[6]Google Forms — Online Survey and Quiz Tool. forms.google.com

Cybercrime Case Study Sources

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[7] The Hindu (October 2024). 'Digital Arrest Scam: Vardhman Group Chairman S.P. Oswal defrauded of Rs 7 crore.' www.thehindu.com

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[9] Kaspersky Official Blog (2024). Analysis of AI-powered social engineering scams in India. www.kaspersky.com/blog

Additional Resources

[13] National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, India. cybercrime.gov.in

[14] National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). Advisory on UPI Collect Request Fraud. www.npci.org.in

[15] Cyber Crime Helpline India: 1930

[16] eSafety Commissioner, Australia. Real Stories of Cyberbullying. www.esafety.gov.au